

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

Sampling & Production Control

End-to-end framework for supplier vetting, sample approval, and production quality control.

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PURPOSE

Overview

Establish a lean, enforceable sampling and production control framework that prevents over-engineered samples, protects commercial margins, and ensures repeatable mass-production quality.



Golden Sample

Golden Sample defines the standard. The benchmark against which all production is measured.



Factory Audit

Factory Audit determines supplier approval. No audit, no PO.



Quality Control

TOP verifies compliance during production. PSI confirms shipment readiness.

STAGE	ACCOUNTABLE	TIMELINE	DESCRIPTION
Stage 0: Factory Pre-Screening & Initial Vetting			
0	Monica	1–3 days	Legal registration, export license, category experience, export history, production capacity, compliance capability, MOQ alignment, communication responsiveness
Stage 1: PP Sample (Pre-Production Sample)			
1	Steven	7–14 days	Early-stage feasibility samples evaluating materials, workmanship, and general capability. Not a production benchmark. Factory produces, Steven reviews & approves, UK photo/video review if required.
Stage 2: Factory Capability Checklist & Virtual Tour			
2	Steven	2–5 days	Validate real production capability before Golden Sample. Factory completes structured checklist. Live video tour verifies production floor, equipment, process flow, and QC stations. Only passing factories proceed.

STAGE 3

Golden Sample (GS) / Approved Pre-Production Sample

Accountable: UK (Commercial) + Steven (Technical) • **Timeline:** 10–14 days production + 3–5 days validation

Official production-standard reference defining materials, construction, finish, functionality, and tolerances. Golden Sample = Definition of Standard.

Key Rule

Golden Sample validation alone does NOT determine PO issuance. The primary deciding factor is the Factory Audit outcome (Stage 4).

Dual Validation Model: UK validates specification & commercial (signed PDF). Steven validates technical realism and manufacturability. Factory retains 1 signed GS master reference. Optional: 1 GS to QC (Katt) for high-risk SKUs.

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	# OF SAMPLES
Factory	Produce GS	As required
Steven	Technical validation	1
UK	Specification confirmation	1 (2 optional)
Factory	Retain signed GS	1 signed master

STAGE 4

Factory Audit (In Person)

Accountable: Steven • **Timeline:** 1 day onsite + 1–2 days reporting

Validate Golden Sample reflects real, repeatable production capability including production line authenticity, BOM compliance, process consistency, and scalability.

STAGE 5

Internal Factory Approval Decision

Accountable: Brand Manager / Head of Supply Chain / Senior Management • **Timeline:** 1–3 days

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Steven	Present audit findings & recommendation
Katt	Provide quality risk input
Brand Manager	Commercial review
Head of Supply Chain	Operational risk review
Senior Management	Final approval authority

STAGE 6

BOM, RFQ, Product Brief & Compliance Lock

Accountable: UK (Commercial) + Steven (Technical) • **Timeline:** 2–7 days

Commercial (UK)

Final BOM (no substitutions)
Unit pricing & terms

Technical (Steven)

Final product specifications
Confirmed manufacturing process
Required certifications & compliance documentation

STAGE 7

Market Reappraisal & Final Commercial Sign-Off

Accountable: Brand Manager + Finance • **Timeline:** 1–3 days

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY
Brand Manager	Reconfirm market viability
Finance (Franc / Jack)	Margin validation
Sim	Final executive approval

STAGE 8

Purchase Order (PO) Issuance

Accountable: Logistics (Nate) • **Timeline:** 1–2 days

PO Condition

PO must reference this SOP and state that shipment and balance payment are conditional upon TOP approval and successful Pre-Shipment Inspection (PSI).

STAGE 9

ISS Creation & Pre-Shipment Inspection Notice

Accountable: Katt • **Timeline:** 2–7 days

- ISS created upon PO issuance
- ISS formally issued to factory
- Written notice confirming Pre-Shipment Inspection (PSI) will be conducted

STAGE 10

Top of Production Sample (TOP)

Accountable: Steven • **Timeline:** During first 10–20% of production

ROLE	RESPONSIBILITY	# OF SAMPLES
Factory	Present & retain signed TOP	1 signed
Steven	Approve TOP onsite based on GS & ISS	1
UK	Review GS vs TOP photo/video	0 physical

STAGE 11

Shipment & Final Payment Release

Accountable: Logistics (Nate) + Accounting • **Timeline:** 1–2 days

Release Conditions

Shipment and balance payment released only after written TOP approval and successful PSI report formally accepted. If production does not match GS: Rework, Replacement, or Rejection at supplier cost.

GOVERNANCE

Governance Principles

Golden Sample

Defines the standard. The benchmark against which all production is measured.

Factory Audit

Determines supplier approval. No audit pass, no purchase order.

TOP Verification

Verifies production compliance during the first 10–20% of the run.

Pre-Shipment Inspection

Confirms shipment readiness. Final gate before dispatch and payment release.